

Tom Jones

Data Platform Engineer | Kafka | Go

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PROFILE

Data Platform Engineer at bet365 owning internal Kafka self-service tooling, broker operations, and high-throughput Go services across on-prem and Google Cloud environments. Build Go microservices, React/TypeScript interfaces, Grafana observability, and CI/CD automation for business-wide platform workflows. Production experience includes KRaft controller/broker setup, rebalancing, consumer lag, ISR/leader allocation, disk/log pressure, retention tuning, and operational tooling used by data platform teams.

CORE SKILLS

Kafka platform: cluster operations, KRaft, broker start/stop/restart, topic creation, partitions, retention, consumer lag, under-replicated partitions, ISR, leader allocation, rebalancing, kcat, SSL/TLS

Tooling & services: Go microservices, React/TypeScript UI, Kafka portal, pub/sub workflows, systemd broker manager, authentication, internal operational shell tooling

Cloud & data: Google Cloud Platform, Google Managed Kafka, Kubernetes workloads, BigQuery, Google Cloud Storage, Cloud Spanner, T-SQL, data archiving, containerisation, logging

Engineering practices: Grafana dashboards, observability, Sarama vs confluent-go benchmarking, GitLab CI, Jenkins, linting, validation, unit tests, deployment jobs, mentoring

EXPERIENCE

Software Developer / Data Platform Engineer | **bet365** - Stoke-on-Trent, UK | *June 2023 - Present*

- Owned and developed business-wide Kafka administration tooling for topic deployment, estate monitoring, pub/sub workflows, broker actions, and operational visibility across data platform teams
- Built Go microservices and React/TypeScript features for an internal Kafka portal, integrating Kafka shell commands, Sarama, confluent-go, systemctl broker controls, T-SQL, Cloud Spanner, and Google Cloud services.
- Developed high-throughput Go services capable of processing and publishing 500k+ messages/sec to Kafka topics across distributed production environments
- Worked directly on on-prem and GCP Kafka clusters, including broker/controller setup, KRaft configuration, rebalancing, broker restarts, topic creation, partition changes, and retention tuning
- Supported production issues including under-replicated partitions, consumer lag, insufficient partitioning, disk pressure, excessive log growth, retention misconfiguration, ISR issues, and leader allocation
- Supported and maintained a large-scale Kafka estate of approximately 600 servers across brokers, ZooKeeper/KRaft controllers, MirrorMaker, Kafka Connect, and observability infrastructure, hosting roughly 3,000 topics
- Improved platform safety and developer experience by replacing manual operational paths with auditable self-service workflows, clearer monitoring, faster diagnostics, and standardised GitLab/Jenkins quality checks
- Implemented Grafana dashboards for tooling APIs, UI health, Kafka lag, and platform observability; benchmarked Sarama vs confluent-go pub/sub approaches to validate throughput and reliability trade-offs

Technologies: Kafka, Go, React, TypeScript, Sarama, confluent-go, Google Cloud, Kubernetes, Cloud Spanner, BigQuery, GCS, T-SQL, Docker, Grafana, GitLab CI, Jenkins

Software Developer | **CityFibre** - Telford, UK | *Dec 2021 - June 2023*

- Developed Python AWS Lambda functions, RESTful APIs, and backend microservices for cross-business data and operational workflows
- Improved pipeline performance by 120% through refactoring hundreds of PHPUnit tests and tightening service feedback loops
- Worked with Kafka, Docker, CI/CD, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Python, PHP, Java, and JavaScript across event-driven services

Technologies: Python, Django, SQLAlchemy, FastAPI, Pytest, Docker, Kafka, Git, PHP, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, AWS Lambda, REST APIs

Software Consultant | **Marell** - Birmingham, UK | *Sep 2017 - Dec 2021*

- Designed and delivered a production Python/SQL solution that saved a major fish processor approximately GBP 250k within the first five days of operation.
- Built operational data processing, reporting, and database performance review solutions for customer environments

Systems Analyst | **ABP Head Office** - Birmingham, UK | *Sep 2016 - Sep 2017*

- Overhauled a legacy traceability system and produced MS SQL reporting across labour cost, throughput, and yield
- Partnered with operational stakeholders to translate business processes into reliable reporting and system changes

IT Technician | **ABP** - Ellesmere, UK | *Aug 2013 - Sep 2016*

- Standardised, configured, and supported systems, applications, networks, Cisco switches, and Active Directory for more than 1,000 employees

EDUCATION

Open University - Bachelor of Science (Honours), Computing and IT (Software) | 2019 - 2025

Shrewsbury College of Arts and Technology - Diploma, ICT Professional Competence / Advanced Apprenticeship, IT, Software, Web & Telecoms | Aug 2013 - Aug 2015

Shrewsbury Sixth Form College - A levels: Computing, Geography, Graphic Design | Sep 2009 - June 2011